Ingredients

- [ ] 5-6 lb. whole chicken
- [ ] Salt/Pepper
- [ ] 1 large bunch thyme, plus 20 sprigs
- [ ] 1 head garlic, cut in half crosswise
- [ ] 1 lemon, halved
- [ ] 2 Tablespoons butter, melted
- [ ] 1 large yellow onion, sliced into large chunks
- [ ] 4 carrots, sliced into 4-inch chunks
- [ ] 1 bulb of fennel, tops removed, cut into wedges
- [ ] 2-3 Tablespoons Olive oil

For the Gravy:

- [ ] 2/3 cup Chicken Broth
- [ ] 3 Tablespoons Butter
- [ ] 3 Tablespoons Flour

Instructions

Roasting the Chicken

1. Unwrap the chicken and remove the giblets and/or the neck (if included). Pat the chicken dry with paper towels.
2. If possible, let the chicken sit at room temperature for 30 minutes to allow for more even cooking.
3. Preheat the oven to 425 degrees.
4. Seasoning the entire chicken generously with salt and pepper.
5. Stuff the chicken with the thyme, garlic, and lemon.
6. Brush the outside of the chicken with the 2 TBS melted butter and season again with salt/pepper.
7. Use kitchen twine to tie the legs together. Tuck the wings underneath the body of the chicken.
8. Place the sliced onions, carrots, and fennel bulb on the bottom of a roasting pan.
9. Sprinkle the vegetables with salt, pepper, 20 sprigs of thyme, and drizzle generously with olive oil. Use your hands to toss to evenly coat the vegetables.
10. Place the chicken **on top** of the vegetables. This prevents the chicken from sitting in its own juice while it cooks and elevates the chicken for even cooking.
11. Roast (uncovered), for 1 ½ hours. Halfway through, use a spoon to drizzle the chicken with some

12. The chicken is done when the juices run clear and the internal temperature reads 165 degrees. (Place a meat thermometer into the thigh to check the temperature.)
13. Let the chicken rest, **uncovered**, for 15-20 minutes to allow the juices to reabsorb before you cut into it!
14. Slice the chicken on a platter and serve with the roasted vegetables.

Making the Gravy

1. Pour the chicken drippings into a large measuring cup.
2. Top it off with chicken broth to make 2 cups.
3. Melt 3 Tablespoons of butter in a saucepan over medium heat.
4. Add 3 Tablespoons flour. Whisk for 1 minute.
5. Add half of the gravy juice/broth. Whisk until there are no lumps.
6. Add remaining liquid. Whisk for 2 minutes. The gravy will continue to thicken more and more.
7. Season with salt/pepper if desired. Done!
8. Notes
9. If your chicken needs a touch more color, increase the heat to 500° and use foil to cover up any parts that are already sufficiently browned.
10. Roast for an additional 5 minutes or so. Keep a close eye on it.

Notes

Need more Browning?

- If your chicken needs a touch more color, increase the heat to 500° and use foil to cover up any parts that are already sufficiently browned.
- Roast for an additional 5 minutes or so. Keep a close eye on it.

Save Your Leftovers!

- Save your leftovers to make easy homemade chicken stock!